



LIONS LIGHT ACADEMY

Google Classroom — A Guide for Families

Getting in, staying in, and the three days that matter

*“It is the glory of God to conceal a matter, but the glory of kings is to
search it out.”*

PROVERBS 25:2

EFFECTIVE

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Ten minutes to set up. Two minutes, three times a week, after that.

Why this matters

Co-op meets one day a week. Everything in between — the reading, the practice, the project that's due next Tuesday — lives in Google Classroom.

A student who never opens it isn't behind because the work was hard. They're behind because they never saw it.

That's the whole reason for this page.

Step one — get the app

It's free, and it's the same app on both phones.

- **iPhone or iPad** — App Store, search **Google Classroom**
- **Android** — Google Play, search **Google Classroom**

The icon is a green chalkboard. The publisher is Google LLC — there are lookalikes, so check that.

No phone? It works in any web browser at **classroom.google.com**. Nothing is lost by using the website instead.

Step two — sign in as the student

This is the step that goes wrong most often, so it's worth slowing down for.

Whatever Google account is signed in on that device is the account that joins the class. If your child taps the invite while your phone is signed in as you, **your** account joins the class — not theirs. The roster then has a parent on it and the student still can't see their work.

Before joining anything:

- Tap the round profile picture in the top right
- Check whose account it is

- If it's the wrong one, add or switch to the student's Google account

If your student doesn't have their own Google account yet, make one before you go further. Trying to share a parent account across two children is where this gets genuinely tangled.

Step three — join the class

There are two ways in, and your teacher will use one of them. You don't get to pick — just follow whichever one you were given.

If you were sent an invitation

The invitation lives in email, and only in email. Nothing appears inside the Classroom app until it's accepted.

1. Open the **email inbox** for the student's Google account
2. Find the message from Classroom — subject line names the class
3. Tap **Join**

If you can't find it, check the spam folder. Classroom invitations land there often enough that it's the first place to look, not the last.

If you were given a class code

A short code, six or seven characters, from the teacher.

1. Open the Classroom app
2. Tap the **+** in the top right
3. Tap **Join class**
4. Type the code exactly as given, then tap **Join**

Sometimes you'll get a link instead of a code. Tapping the link does the same thing with less typing.

One code per class

Your student may be enrolled in more than one LLA class, and **each one has its own code or its own invitation.** Joining one doesn't join the others. If a class seems to be missing, that's usually why.

Step four — check it Wednesday, Friday, Monday

This is the part that actually matters, and it takes about two minutes each time.

Three checks a week, each doing a different job:

Wednesday — see what was assigned. The day after co-op, while it's still fresh. Open it together with your student and read what's due. Nothing has to be done yet. You're just looking.

Friday — start it, and ask questions. There's still a whole weekend. If something doesn't make sense, this is the day to email the teacher and actually get an answer before it's urgent.

Monday — the night-before check. Anything unfinished is still fixable tonight. Tuesday morning is too late, and a rushed job on the way to co-op isn't the point.

Put those three as a repeating reminder on your phone. It is easier to keep a rhythm than to remember a task.

What to look at when you're in there

Open the class, then tap **Classwork** at the bottom.

The **Stream** is the announcement feed. It's useful, but assignments can scroll off it. **Classwork** is the real list, and it shows what's assigned, what's due, and what's been turned in.

When a piece of work is done, open it and tap **Turn in**. Work that's finished but never turned in looks exactly like work that was never done.

If something looks wrong

The class is empty, or isn't there at all. The invitation was never accepted. It's sitting in an email inbox — check the student's mail and the spam folder.

You're in, but it's the wrong account. Sign out, sign in as the student, and join again. Tell us so we can remove the wrong one from the roster.

The code doesn't work. Codes get reset after everyone joins. Email us and we'll send a fresh invitation.

Nothing's been posted yet. That happens, especially early in the year. Check again Friday before assuming something is broken.

One thing worth knowing

Our Code of Conduct treats **required work not completed for two class sessions in a row** as a Moderate concern — the level that carries a documented warning.

That's not meant as a threat. It's the reason this page exists. Almost every student who reaches that point got there by not seeing the work, not by refusing it.

Three two-minute checks a week is how that never happens.

Questions

Email lionslightacademy2025@gmail.com — that's the co-op's address and it's the one we watch.

Tell us which class and which student, and say what you're seeing on the screen. We'll sort it out.